Honda Civic Diagnostic Trouble Code (DTC) Reference & Sensor Testing

Manufacturer: **Honda** | Model: **Civic** | Model Year: **2023** | Type: **diagnostic_matrix**
Engine Architecture: **Civic R18, L15, L15BG, LFC** | Transmission: **All Transmissions**
Official Source Repository: https://honda.com.pk/after-sales/obd2-troubleshooting/

1. Technical Specifications & Capacities

Parameter	Factory Specification	Inspection Interval
Engine Oil Type	0W-20 / 5W-30 API SP/SN Full Synthetic	Every 5,000 km (Pakistan Severe Profile)
Engine Oil Sump Capacity	3.7 - 4.2 Litres (with filter replacement)	Check weekly on level ground
Cooling System Coolant	Ethylene Glycol 50/50 Pre-mixed (Long Life)	Inspect level monthly, replace 80,000 km
Transmission Lubricant	All Transmissions	Inspect every 20,000 km / Replace 40,000 km
Brake Fluid Specification	DOT 3 / DOT 4 Polyethylene Glycol	Inspect level monthly, flush every 2 years
Cold Tyre Pressure	32 PSI (Front) / 32 PSI (Rear)	Inspect weekly when tyres are cold

2. Critical Safety Instructions & Warning Indicators

WARNING: ENGINE OVERHEATING EMERGENCIES
If the engine coolant temperature gauge enters the RED zone, or steam escapes from under the hood: Immediately pull over to a safe area away from moving traffic and shift transmission into Park/Neutral. Turn off air conditioning immediately. DO NOT open the radiator cap or pressurized coolant reservoir while hot. Scalding pressurized coolant will cause catastrophic skin burns. Wait at least 30 minutes until the engine is completely cold before inspecting the coolant level or checking for burst radiator hoses.

CAUTION: ENGINE OIL PRESSURE WARNING LIGHT
The oil lamp indicator signals a loss of oil pressure, NOT oil level. If illuminated while driving, stop the vehicle immediately and turn off the engine. Continued operation under zero or low oil pressure will seize bearings and permanently destroy the engine block within 30 seconds. Verify oil dipstick level and check for catastrophic oil filter or sump puncture.

DANGER: BRAKE SYSTEM WEAR & BRAKE WARNING LIGHT
Brake pads include built-in acoustic wear indicators. When pad thickness drops below 1.0 mm, a metallic screeching sound occurs during braking. If the red brake warning light remains lit with the parking brake fully released, a hydraulic leak or dangerously low fluid level is present. Do not drive the vehicle. Arrange emergency towing.

3. Vehicle Subsystem Architecture & Diagnostic Procedures

- **Subsystem Guideline:** P0300 Random misfire causes and injector testing
- **Subsystem Guideline:** P0299 Turbocharger underboost condition
- **Subsystem Guideline:** P0172 System too rich (bank 1) fuel trim test
- **Subsystem Guideline:** P0848 3rd clutch transmission fluid pressure switch high
- **Subsystem Guideline:** P16E3 Engine coolant temperature circuit malfunction

4. Diagnostic Trouble Code (DTC) Matrix Reference

OBD-II Code	Fault Description	Primary Mechanical Root Causes
P0300	Random / Multiple Cylinder Misfire Detected	Failing ignition coils, worn spark plugs, low fuel pressure, vacuum leak
P0171	System Too Lean (Bank 1)	Dirty MAF sensor, vacuum intake leak, clogged fuel injectors, weak fuel pump
P0420	Catalytic Converter System Efficiency Below Threshold	Exhaust leak ahead of converter, failing downstream O2 sensor, carbon fouling
P0117	Engine Coolant Temperature Circuit Low Input	Stuck closed thermostat, failed ECT sensor, short in wiring harness
P0700	Transmission Control System Malfunction	Degraded CVT fluid, valve body solenoid failure, overheated fluid sensor

Note on Verification: Workshop repair estimates that recommend major replacements (e.g., complete transmission or catalytic converter replacement) must be verified against actual scanner live sensor data and basic component checks (e.g. spark plugs, fluid age, wiring continuity) before authorization.